CUSTOMER CASE STUDY · 2026

Pinewood × Atlas

How a 40-year-old furniture maker doubled output without adding a shift.

Pinewood was turning away orders it had the demand for but not the capacity.

Pinewood Furniture, a family-run manufacturer since 1984, had a two-year backlog and rising costs. Its bottleneck was the finishing line — manual, slow, and impossible to staff. Atlas Robotics automated it, and the numbers tell the rest.

- A 12-week order backlog and a labor market that couldn't fill the gap.
- Atlas deployed in 90 days; this is what changed.

The challenge: demand Pinewood couldn't meet and labor it couldn't hire.

Orders were up 40% post-pandemic, but the finishing line — sanding, staining, sealing — ran one shift because skilled finishers were impossible to recruit. Every order queued behind that single constraint.

- 12-week lead times were costing Pinewood deals to faster competitors.
- Three open finisher roles sat unfilled for over a year.

THE CONSTRAINT THAT CAPPED THE BUSINESS

12 wk

order lead time, set entirely by a single-shift finishing line that Pinewood couldn't staff.

BEFORE AND AFTER

The finishing line went from the bottleneck to the fastest stage on the floor.

The Atlas cell took over sanding, staining, and sealing — running unattended across two shifts where one had barely run before.

BEFORE ATLAS

- One manual shift, 80 units a day
- 12-week lead time, three unfilled roles

AFTER ATLAS

- Two automated shifts, 190 units a day
- 4-week lead time, finishers redeployed to QA

RECOMMENDATION

Output more than doubled without a single new finisher hire.

The win wasn't replacing people — it was redeploying them to better work.

Pinewood didn't lay anyone off. The finishers who couldn't be fully staffed became quality inspectors and cell supervisors, higher-skilled roles that the automation actually created demand for.

- Zero layoffs; three finishers moved into QA and supervision.
- The Atlas cell runs lights-out on the second shift.

RESULTS · 12 MONTHS POST-DEPLOYMENT

One year in, the line is faster, cheaper, and more consistent.

Measured against Pinewood's pre-deployment baseline, same product mix.

+138%
DAILY OUTPUT

−67%
LEAD TIME

−31%
COST PER UNIT

99.4%
FINISH QUALITY

IMPACT · YEAR ONE

Pinewood doubled output, cut lead time two-thirds, and grew revenue 44%.

190

Units per day

UP FROM 80 2.4× OUTPUT MEASURED

4 wk

Order lead time

DOWN FROM 12 -67% VERIFIED

+44%

Revenue YoY

ON FILLED BACKLOG 12-MO AUDITED

PAYBACK · YEAR ONE

The Atlas cell paid for itself in under eight months.

7.4 mo

Payback period

ON FULL DEPLOYMENT ACHIEVED FINANCE

$1.9M

Year-one savings

LABOR + SCRAP + REWORK
MEASURED OPS

31%

Cost per unit cut

SUSTAINED AT SCALE 12-MO
AUDITED

“

We didn't lose a single person — we doubled what we make and moved our best people to the work that matters. Atlas paid for itself before the year was out.

”

— Daniel Pinewood, Owner & CEO, Pinewood Furniture

ATLAS ROBOTICS · ATLASROBOTICS.EXAMPLE · SALES@ATLASROBOTICS.EXAMPLE

Same team. Twice the output.